

THE
POWER
PLAYBOOK

HOW TO WIN AT WORK



MasterClass

MORE POWER TO YOU

YOUR POWER PLAYBOOK

CHEAT SHEET

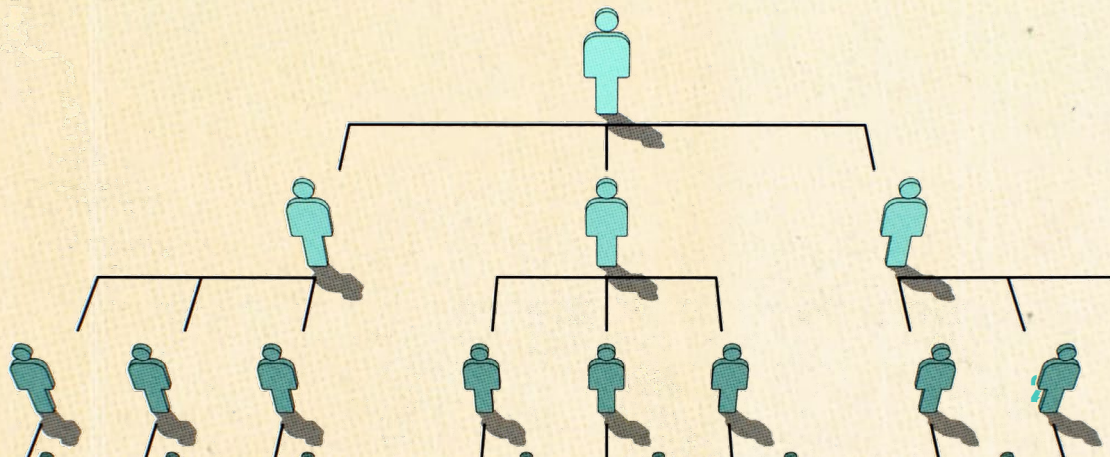
Professor Jeffrey Pfeffer has taught the social science of power and organizational management to future world leaders in politics and business, including UK Prime Minister Rishi Sunak and future top executives at major companies such as OpenAI, Meta, and X.

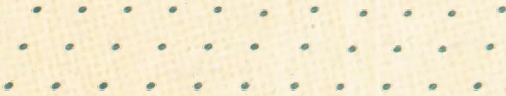
If you've watched *The Power Playbook: How to Win at Work*, you've hopefully absorbed some of Pfeffer's key lessons yourself. Below is a recap of the main takeaways from each chapter of the class, as well as a list of action items that will offer you a chance to put them into practice.

Professor Pfeffer encourages you to experiment with each action item after watching the relevant chapter, so you can better understand the context in which they can be applied.

While there are no strict rules, it's best to pace yourself. Aim to complete one chapter per week rather than trying to implement all the action items at once.

Explore, have fun, and as Professor Pfeffer shares in the class, "Rise as high as you want."





CHAPTER 1

MAP YOUR POWER

RECAP

- Prioritize “person-job fit” when considering a new position.
- Search job title and company name — what happened to whoever held the position before you?
- Make a personal power map.
- Brag about your accomplishments.

ACTION ITEMS

- If your company has one, review an organization chart, taking note of the people you have access to.
 - Create a power map of your company. List five to seven individuals within your organization who hold significant power, and don’t neglect people lower down in the company hierarchy who might wield significant influence.
 - Now ask yourself, “Do these people know who I am and recognize my work? If not, what can I do to change that?”
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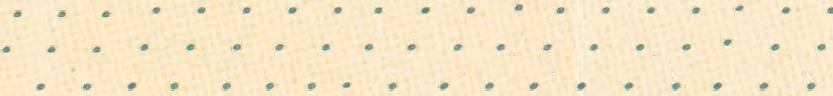
CHAPTER 2

MANAGING UP

RECAP

- There’s no such thing as too much flattery.
- Avoid directly criticizing people who hold more power than you.
- Make your good idea seem like your boss’s good idea.
- Don’t underestimate the willingness of others to help you.

ACTION ITEMS

- First, compliment someone in a position above you.
 - Second, ask someone for guidance.
 - Then ask yourself, “How did that feel?”
 - What was the result?
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CHAPTER 3

THE ART OF EXECUTIVE PRESENCE

RECAP

- Rehearse and prepare for your first day on the job.
- How you look and sound is more important than what you say.
- Counteract self-doubt by acting confident.
- Don't overshare personal information at work.

ACTION ITEMS

- Volunteer to speak at a company meeting where you've never spoken before.
 - Afterwards, get feedback from a colleague. Based upon that feedback, what strategies can you apply the next time you speak in front of an unfamiliar audience?
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CHAPTER 4

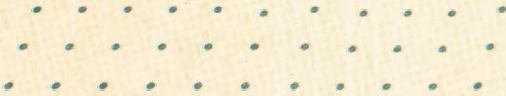
BUILD YOUR OWN BRAND

RECAP

- Decide what your brand is, promote it, and stay consistent.
- Cultivate a look and style that is consistent with your brand.
- Your brand statement should be short and to the point.
- Use social media to disseminate your brand.

ACTION ITEMS

- Focus on one particular aspect of your wardrobe or personal style that you can cultivate and stick with it for a few days. What reaction do you receive?
 - Try booking an appearance at a conference, on a podcast, or at a community event to represent your brand. You could even do stand-up comedy! The goal is to practice speaking in front of total strangers and get them to understand your brand.
 - Afterwards, reflect on how it went and what you could do better next time.
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CHAPTER 5

BUILDING USEFUL NETWORKS

RECAP

- Network for at least one hour a day, every day.
- Get out of your comfort zone to build new connections; weak ties are the most important.
- Networking should be an act of generosity — use it to connect people.

ACTION ITEMS

- Make a list of 10 important people that you consider weak ties, and try to set meetings with two of them. One should be an internal connection, and one should be external.
 - What are the takeaways from those meetings? How can you leverage them for further networking opportunities?
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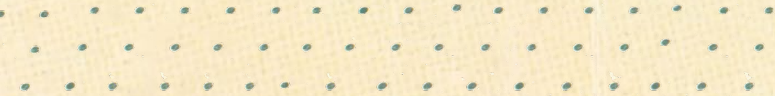
CHAPTER 6

BREAK THE RULES

RECAP

- Rule followers rarely find their way to the top.
- Only break the rules if you think you can get away with it.
- Take responsibility, solve problems, but never apologize.
- Don't wait for permission — power favors those who move first.

ACTION ITEMS

- Do something that you think will benefit your organization, but without asking for permission first. This could include exploring promotional opportunities for a new product launch or an out-of-the-box plan for growing the business.
 - Note that this should be something that advances your position but does not jeopardize your career.
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CHAPTER 7

HOLDING ON TO POWER ONCE YOU HAVE IT

RECAP

- The higher you rise, the bigger the target on your back.
- Consider strategic outplacement as a way to outmaneuver your rivals.
- Delegate noncritical tasks — you can't do it all.
- Power causes people to come over to your side.

ACTION ITEMS

- All of us have strengths we can develop and flaws we can work on. Now that you've completed the class, what are the three lessons that resonate the most with you?
- Identify ways to implement these teachings in your daily life, and make an effort to apply them consistently. As you do, notice how they influence both your behavior and the way others respond to you.
- How have your views on power changed, and how can you make them work for you?